

Compiling a bright future through open source

Turning what you learn into a public record no one can take back.

think does not end with a certificate. It ends with a portfolio you can point to — a device driver you wrote, and real, merged open-source contributions with your name on them. For someone rebuilding after prison, that is the difference between asking to be trusted and showing the proof.

For **justice-impacted people in the reentry window**, think is a systems course that ends in **real open-source contributions** — verifiable, public proof of skill — where a bootcamp hands you a certificate that only says you attended.

WHY OPEN SOURCE, FOR THIS AUDIENCE

01 A record that does not ask about your past

In open source the review judges the patch, not the person. Contributions are public and merit-judged; nobody on the mailing list asks where you have been.

02 Proof you can point to

83% of organizations weigh open-source contributions when they hire. A merged patch outweighs a gap in your history, because it is evidence, not a claim.

03 A door, and a community

The work introduces you. Established on-ramps (kernelnewbies, the Linux Kernel Mentorship Program, Outreachy) mean you are not walking in alone.

A certificate says: I showed up. A merged patch says: I did this. It is in the code, my name is on it, and it is still there.

You do not graduate with a promise. You graduate with a history.

Source: 2024 Open Source Software Funding Survey (GitHub, the Linux Foundation, and Harvard): 83% of organizations say open-source contribution is at least somewhat important for prospective hires.